

Combo Manager: Quick Start

Combo Manager keeps the semester's combos, makes the show calendar, and helps with swaps during the semester. Everything happens in one window: you click buttons, you never type commands.

First time on a computer (once)

- 1 **Windows:** unzip **Combo Manager** anywhere (e.g. Documents; not in the data folder) and double-click **Combo Manager.exe**. If Windows says "Windows protected your PC", click **More info**, then **Run anyway** (once). **Mac:** open the program folder and double-click *Combo Manager.command* (if it can't be opened: **System Settings > Privacy & Security > Open Anyway**; the first time, click **Install** and wait a minute).
- 2 It asks for its **data folder** (it holds everything): **Choose existing folder** (e.g. the shared *Combo Manager data* in OneDrive), or **Make a new folder**. From now on, opening the program is all you need.

While combos sign up (Combos tab)

- Combos come in through the sign-up form (approve them in Outlook, then **Sync**), or add one yourself: right-click, **New combo**.
- Right-click a combo or a person to add or remove a member, change the liaison, fix a name or email, **Edit conflicts**, or withdraw a combo. Changes are saved when you click **Confirm changes** (the bar under the list).
- **Check combos** lists anything to look at (typos, missing members, conflicts that match nobody).

Making the schedule (once, after sign-ups close)

- 1 **Settings** tab: check the semester name, the first and last show day, and the skip dates (reading week, holidays). Click **Save settings**. If it asks about moving last semester's files, click **Yes**.
- 2 **Schedule** tab: **Make schedule**. Wait up to a minute or two. **Open PDF** (the calendar) or **Open Excel** (one table per night); the combo list is on the Combos tab. Print or send them.
- 3 Once it's sent to students, tick **Lock schedule**: then a new schedule can't be made by accident.

During the semester

- **A combo can't make a show:** **Swaps** tab, pick the combo and the show, pick an option, click **Add to pending changes**, then **Confirm changes**. **Copy swap summary** and **Copy liaison emails** give you an email ready to send. The PDF and Excel files update themselves.
- **Emails for a night:** **Schedule** tab, right-click the night, **Copy combo emails** (or the liaisons'), then paste into Outlook.
- **Check schedule** (Schedule tab) is always safe: it checks every rule after swaps.

If something goes wrong

- Red text in a results box says what's wrong: read it first. *Something went wrong:* **About > Open the log** and email that file to the person in the **About** tab.
- **Backup...** (top right) now and then: the whole data folder as one zip. Keep it off this computer. **Restore...** brings one back (what's there now is saved first).
- **New computer?** Do the first-time steps again, then choose the same data folder, or restore a backup. Use one computer at a time (the app says if it is open elsewhere).